



Encrypt files

necessary). Once it's encrypted, when you right-click on it, you will see the Decrypt option.



Hide The Floppy Drive

You no longer use a floppy drive these days, so there's no reason for it to be displayed in My Computer. Open the Registry Editor and go to HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer. If this key does not exist, create it. The modify or create a 32-bit DWORD named NoDrives. Assign it a value of 1.



Jagged Fonts?

If you just bought a Vista PC, chances are you'll find that the fonts are jagged and hard to read. Manufacturers generally disable font smoothing, because that feature imposes a penalty on PC performance. You can enable font smoothing by opening the Classic Appearance Settings, clicking the Effects button, and checking the box against Font Smoothing. Revert if you notice a considerable slowdown.



Share Folders As Easily As In XP

In Vista, when you right-click on a folder and click Share, a Wizard starts, which is meant to make things easier, but in reality is a bit confusing for many ex-XP users. You cannot choose the share

name and will instead be assigned a weird name such as \\computer\Users\Username\Data. To share in the XP way, click Properties instead of Share. Select the Sharing tab and click Advanced Sharing. Check the box against Share this folder and choose a share name. You can also set permissions here.



Symlinks in Vista

One of the interesting features of Linux—symbolic links—finally makes an appearance in Windows. You can create symlinks using the command-line utility mklink. The syntax is as below:

mklink [[/D] | [/H] | [/J]] Link Target

where:

/D Creates a directory symbolic link (soft link). Default is a file symbolic link
/H Creates a hard link (link to a file) instead of a symbolic link
/J Creates a Directory Junction

Link Specifies the new symbolic link name
Target Specifies the path (relative or absolute) that the new link refers to

For example, if you want to make D:\Data to be available from the folder D:\Maindata, use C:\mklink /D D:\Maindata D:\Data

If you now look in D:\Maindata, you'll see whatever files were in the other directory.

AMAROK

Amarok is an extremely powerful yet simple audio player for KDE. The beauty of this player is that it goes the extra mile by providing detailed information about the currently playing song, music by the same artist, and so on. It even has support for Apple's iPod, iRiver's ifp, and a multitude of generic USB devices.



An Alarm Clock

You can very easily set up Amarok to work as an alarm clock. The command used here is dcopy, which

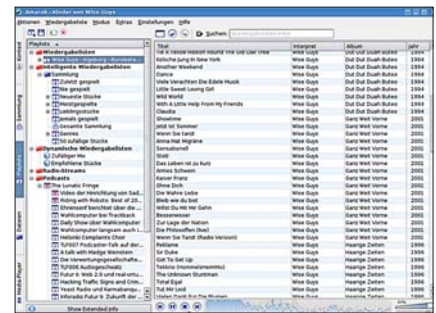


Bet You Didn't Know



Detach

The Amarok player analysers can be detached from the Player window. Just press [D] on your keyboard to open the active analyser in an independent, resizable window.



Amarok player

instructs Amarok player to play. Here is the syntax:

```
%`kde-config --
prefix`/bin/dcopy --user USERNAME
amarok player play
```

This command will tell Amarok to start playing. Just make sure Amarok is running when you go to bed, and it will wake you up to the tune of whatever you last pressed Stop on.

Also check out the Amarok script named weekalarm, downloadable from <http://kde-apps.org/CONTENT/content-files/23160-weekalarm-0.9.1.amarokscript.tar.bz2>. This is a versatile alarm script for Amarok, and it includes the ability to set different alarm times for each day, use wake-up playlists, control volume fading, and enable snoozing.



Listen In

In a properly set up ssh environment, you can get information about what is being played on Amarok on your computer from another computer on a network. The following command will return the Now Playing string.

```
ssh -i ~/.ssh/id_rsa YourIP dcopy
--user YourUserName amarok
player nowPlaying
```

Also note that this expects your identification to be found in the ~/.ssh/id_rsa file.

The Amarok settings file can be found at

```
~/.kde/share/apps/amarok
~/.kde/share/config/amarokrc
```



Bet You Didn't Know

Shortcuts

Hold down [Ctrl] and click the right mouse button to enqueue files in the order in which you clicked them. Press [Enter] after a playlist search to play the first search item and clear the search results.